



**Q** I was overweight before I became pregnant. Should I try not to gain weight now?

Never restrict your calorie intake during pregnancy: your baby and you need a basic level of nourishment in order to remain healthy.

This is true for whatever your weight was before you discovered you were pregnant. However, that basic level of nourishment can be slightly different depending upon your weight at the beginning of your pregnancy.

To find out if your pre-pregnancy weight is within normal range, calculate your body mass index (BMI). You can do this up until 8 weeks of pregnancy since you won't have put on a significant amount of weight by this time. Calculate by dividing your weight in kilograms by your height in meters, then divide it again

(or, use pounds and inches with an online BMI converter). You don't need to consume extra calories during the first and second trimesters—the recommended 2,000 per day is sufficient. In the third trimester you may need to eat 200–300 extra calories per day. Always discuss calorie intake and weight with your doctor before doing any “counting;” the most important thing is that you get enough calories and nutrients for your baby to grow properly. If you don't get enough, you can face a pregnancy that results in birth defects or other problems.

### WEIGHT GAIN DURING PREGNANCY

The table below shows the ideal weight gain during pregnancy for each of the four BMI categories—underweight, ideal weight, overweight, obese.

| WEIGHT              | BMI            | WEIGHT GAIN          | IDEAL WEEKLY WEIGHT GAIN                                                        |
|---------------------|----------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Underweight</b>  | less than 18.5 | 28–40 lb (14–17 kg)  | approx 2¼–3 lb (1–1.2 kg) every two weeks in the second and third trimesters    |
| <b>Ideal weight</b> | 18.5 to 24.9   | 25–35 lb (11–16 kg)  | approx 1¾–2¼ lb (800 g–1 kg) every two weeks in the second and third trimesters |
| <b>Overweight</b>   | 25 to 29.9     | 15–25 lb (7–11.5 kg) | approx 1–1¾ lb (500–800 g) every two weeks in the second and third trimesters   |
| <b>Obese</b>        | 30 or higher   | 11–20 lb (4.5–9 kg)  | approx ½–1¼ lb (300–600 g) every two weeks in the second and third trimesters   |

**Q** A few years ago I was bulimic. Is this significant now that I'm pregnant?

**During pregnancy, your baby receives all its nourishment from you.** If your reserves are depleted you can become malnourished and as a result risk having a baby with abnormally low birth weight and other possible problems. If you are suffering from an eating disorder such as bulimia or anorexia, or you are worried that a previous condition will return, you need to inform your doctor. He or she can help you by providing emotional support throughout your pregnancy and also put a plan in place, if you need it, to help you have a healthy pregnancy.

**Q** How long will it take me to get back to my pre-pregnancy weight after the birth?

**That entirely depends on how much weight you gain during your pregnancy, whether you breast-feed, and how much of a concerted effort**

Learn to love your  
**“mommy tummy.”**

Even when they lose their pregnancy weight, **some women never have the same figure** they had before they had their baby. Although this may cause wardrobe inconvenience, a different body shape—**curves** and angles in **different places**—it doesn't mean a body that is less attractive. In fact, it could be the start of a whole new image that you love even more than the last.